

Kamal Joshi

Security Engineering Technical Leader | Go | Cloud Security | Policy-as-Code | AI-Driven Automation

Austin, TX | Open to remote-friendly roles within the U.S. | Open to relocation for the right opportunity
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Security Engineering Technical Leader with 18+ years of experience building security platforms, automating compliance controls, enforcing policy-as-code, and driving security architecture across cloud-native systems at Cisco scale. Hands-on with Go, Java, AWS, Terraform, OPA, and Kubernetes — with a track record of reducing manual review effort through automation, translating security requirements into scalable engineering solutions, and leading cross-team security initiatives from design through production. Brings deep AI-assisted engineering fluency — daily use of Claude Code, Copilot, and Codex — with the ability to leverage AI/LLM frameworks to address security gaps and accelerate automation delivery.

ROLE ALIGNMENT

- **Security automation and policy-as-code:** OPA (deployed as authorization policy sidecar, 2020–2021), Terraform IaC automation, compliance validation, multi-region deployment guardrails
- **Cloud security architecture:** AWS Lambda, ECS, EKS, S3, SQS/SNS, DynamoDB, Secrets Manager, multi-account Terraform; sovereign/GovCloud environment hardening
- **Security controls and enforcement:** API gateway policy enforcement, OAuth 2.0 / OIDC authorization, API key management, rate-limit governance, secure coding (100+ OWASP warnings → zero)
- **DevSecOps and compliance:** ISMAP security certification leadership; automated validation across ECR, Secrets Manager, DynamoDB, SNS; Kubernetes-based service deployments
- **Technical leadership and cross-team collaboration:** architecture reviews, security incident response, cross-team integration design, mentoring, documentation
- **AI/LLM for automation:** daily Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Codex across implementation, IaC, testing, and design; pioneered team-wide AI tooling adoption; working familiarity with agentic tool patterns (LLM + memory + tool use)

EXPERIENCE

Cisco

Software Engineering Technical Leader

November 2025 - May 2026 | Austin, TX

- Designed and implemented security controls and automated validation across sovereign and multi-region environments, decomposing a high-risk Terraform rollout into staged compliance checkpoints across ECR, Secrets Manager, DynamoDB streams, SNS, and audit logging.
- Led security architecture reviews and cross-service design for customer-selected Splunk and CloudEvents security-event formats across alerts, integrations, and notifications services — defining event models and enforcing delivery standards across four platform services.
- Drove automated security compliance readiness for integrations-svc across TerraSecure and GovCloud environments, coordinating ECR, Secrets Manager, service config, and audit logging with scoped validation at each step.
- Resolved a customer-scale API security failure by tracing **250+ appliance registration requests** through API key authentication and APIGW rate-limit enforcement, driving durable fixes around retry/backoff, token reuse, and service ownership.
- Prevented security-event message loss during a production incident by identifying a **300k+ message DLQ backlog**, quantifying impact across **15 orgs**, and executing remediation within **5-10 minutes**.
- Led design and delivery of real-time push security events capability using the open **CloudEvents** standard, delivering **alpha on schedule (Nov 2025)** with a team of three engineers.

- Mapped AuthSvc TLS secret synchronization and API key refresh behavior across deployment tooling, Secrets Manager, Kubernetes, and Kong — reducing ambiguity for security-sensitive automation and reducing risk in secret rotation workflows.

Senior Software Engineer

January 2021 - November 2025 | Austin, TX

- Deployed **OPA (Open Policy Agent)** as an authorization policy sidecar for service-level policy enforcement, translating security requirements into automated, scalable policy controls.
- Built auth-tools, an internal authorization library adopted across multiple platform services to standardize OAuth/policy enforcement and reduce inconsistent security implementations.
- Led **ISMAP security certification** for the APIX platform, coordinating cross-functional compliance requirements, automated validation, and audit evidence across engineering and operations teams.
- Integrated AI tooling (Claude Code, Copilot, Codex) into daily engineering workflow across the full SDLC; pioneered team-wide GitHub Copilot adoption ahead of broader Cisco initiatives; initiated “Tip Talk Tue” knowledge-sharing forum on engineering productivity and security practices.

Randstad Technologies US at Cisco

Senior Software Developer

March 2015 - January 2021 | Dublin, OH

- Designed and implemented Go-based gRPC and JSON/HTTP APIs for a cloud-native data ingestion platform; contributed to automatic generation of protocol buffer specs from SQL schemas.
- Built API-driven authentication and authorization flows using **OIDC, OAuth 2.0**, and gRPC-Web interactions.
- Designed a type-assisted search feature for an **Active Threat Analytics** dashboard, reducing friction for security analysts writing threat-hunting queries.
- Reduced **100+ OWASP-reported security warnings to zero** through secure coding practices, browser security headers, input sanitization, and server-side validation.

Earlier Engineering Experience

Cognizant, Oracle, Collabera | December 2007 - February 2015

- Delivered backend services, internal tools, and integration features across financial services, healthcare, insurance, and public-sector domains.
- Built a foundation in Java, REST APIs, service integrations, automation, and secure engineering practices.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate
- AWS Certified Developer - Associate
- MongoDB Certified Java Developer M101J
- Google Cloud Platform Essentials

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Information Technology
Dharmsinh Desai University